

WAGES IN A CRUNCH

SALARIED EMPLOYEES HAVE BEEN FACING AN UPHILL BATTLE FOR THE LAST FEW YEARS WITH MOST SEEING SUBDUED HIKEs EVEN AS INDIA INC'S PROFITS SURGED. WILL PAYCHECKS BLOOM THIS YEAR?

BY SURABHI



ID TO LATE single digits. That's the consensus estimate of salary increments in 2025 among HR and staffing firms. The reasons: Global economic uncertainties and fears of a possible recession in the US.

"As Indian companies navigate global and local headwinds, there is a clear focus on optimising compensation budgets, with pay increases for 2025 being forecast at 8.8% (9% in 2024). The survey shows that 75% companies will either reduce or keep their pay increases the same as last year," says the third edition of the Deloitte India Talent Outlook 2025, noting that the average increment is expected to be the lowest in a decade, barring 2020-21.

